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# AI and Human Judgement

How to use artificial intelligence professionally without losing critical thinking

*Artificial intelligence as an assistant and work tool, not an authority accepted uncritically*

Does AI make us smarter, or just faster?

# Speaker

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*Public affairs and strategic communications consultant*

- ~20 years of experience in communications, political processes and regulatory affairs
- Founder and former Managing Director of Golin Riga (12+ years)
- Deputy Chair, LCCI Services Council and Competition Neutrality Committee
- Member, NTSP Public Security Sub-Council since 2014
- Daily user of ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, NotebookLM, Perplexity, Copilot and other AI tools
- Founder and developer, ZEVON AI Reputation Intelligence.

ZEVON analyses how AI tools describe a company or organisation, which sources they use, and how to improve accuracy, credibility and consistency in AI-generated results.

*Uses AI tools daily and knows exactly where critical thinking is essential.*

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# From using tools to creating business value

*Three levels of AI value in an organisation*

1.

## DEFEND

*Maintain productivity*

**Return on Employee**

Employees use AI safely and critically in their daily work

2.

## EXTEND

*Improve processes*

**Return on Investment**

Teams redesign work processes with AI

3.

## UPEND

*Create new models*

**Return on Future**

The organisation creates new services, products or operating models

Organisations should begin at the "Defend" level: safe, critical and high-quality use of AI in daily work.

Source: Gartner, The 3 AI Business Outcomes That Matter: ROI, ROE, ROF, 2025; Gartner framework as summarised in public materials on Defend / Extend / Upend GenAI business cases.

# AI and Human Judgement

## Three main risks of using artificial intelligence

01

### Cognitive offloading

*cognitive offloading*

Thinking is outsourced to a tool, reducing the person's own cognitive engagement.

02

### Overreliance

*over-reliance*

A person follows AI output even when independent verification is needed.

03

### Automation bias

*automation bias*

A tendency to place excessive trust in automatically generated recommendations or overlook errors simply because they came from a system.

Sources: Gerlich (2025), Zhai et al. (2024), Romeo & Conti (2025/2026)

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## Professional audit of an AI response

1
### Purpose
What am I trying to achieve?

2
### Facts
What can be verified here?

3
### Logic
Is the conclusion well-founded?

4
### Perspectives
Which perspective is missing?

5
### Applicability
Does this fit my situation?

6
### Accountability
Would I put my name to this?

Sources: Paul & Elder (2020), Korosec-Serfaty et al. (2026)